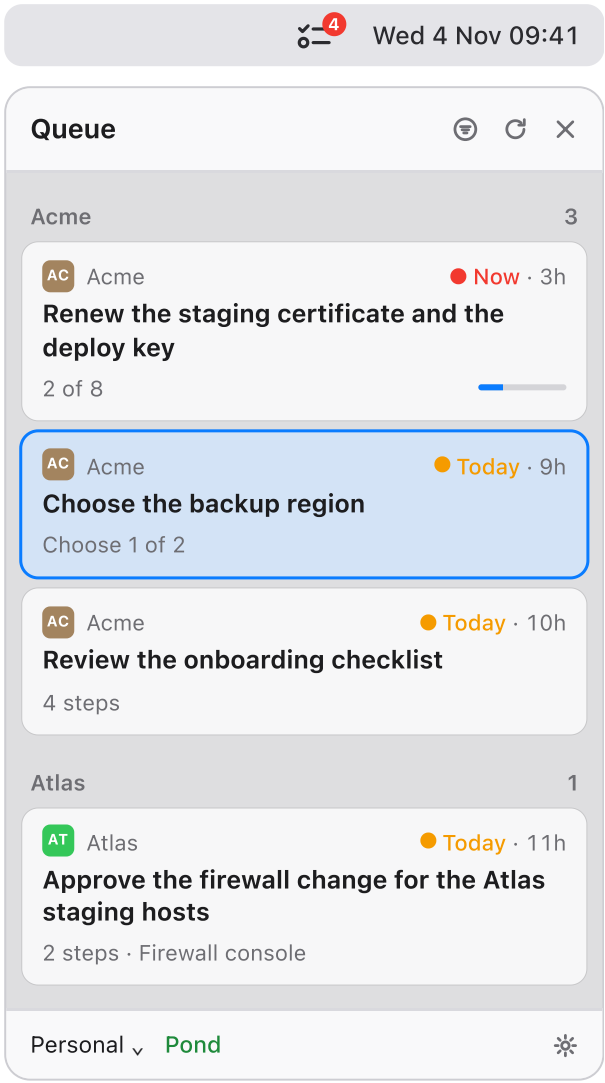
Hook

Everything your coding agents need from you, in one calm queue on your Mac.

When a session needs a key, a decision or a manual step, it lands in Hook as numbered steps with exact commands and a Copy button. You follow them, press Done or reply, and the session that asked carries on with your answer.

- One queue for Claude Code, Codex, Cursor and 15 more agents
- Steps you can follow without stopping to think
- Your answer goes back to the session by itself



The badge counts open asks; ^⌥⌘R shows the panel from any app. The status bar names the queue you're looking at.

01

WHY HOOK

Sessions get stuck on you

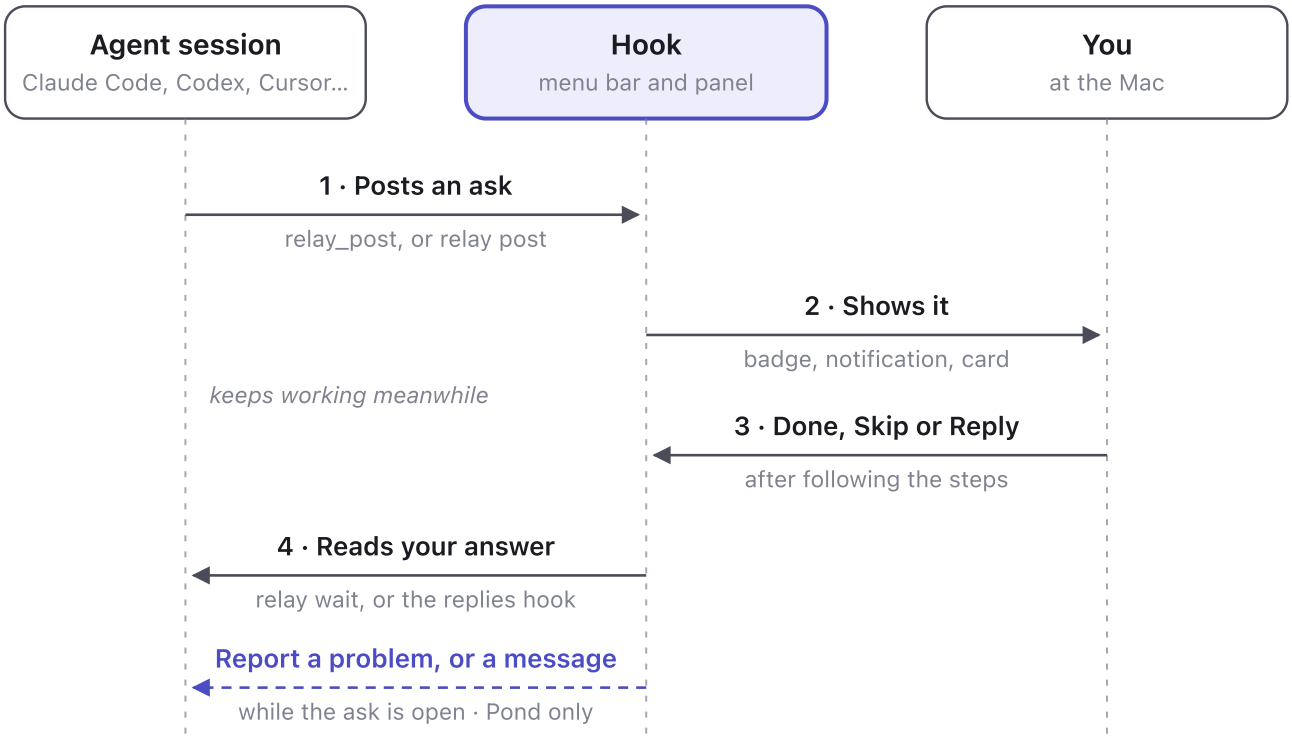
A coding session regularly reaches something only you can do: paste an API key, click through a web console, approve a migration, or choose between two options. It writes a line saying it is waiting on you, and that line scrolls away with the rest of the session. With several agents running, nobody keeps track of who is waiting for what.

Hook turns each of those moments into an ask: a short, exact checklist, in one queue you can open from any app. Your answer goes back to the session that asked, so it can carry on.

02

HOW IT WORKS

One round trip per ask



The session never waits idle: it carries on and picks up your answer when it comes.

This Mac only

The default. The queue lives inside Hook, in a file in your Library folder, served only on 127.0.0.1. Asks never leave the Mac.

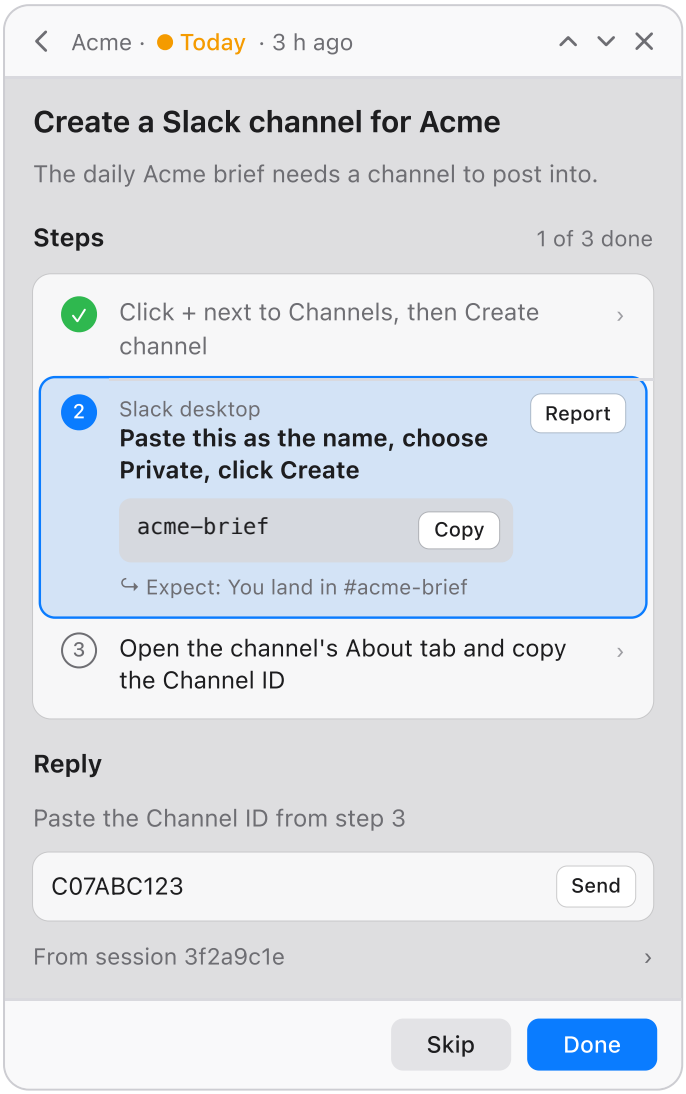
Pond

A small server you run holds the queue, and Hook checks it every 15 seconds. Asks can then reach you away from the Mac, on Telegram. Hook ships no Pond server.

AN ASK, UP CLOSE

03 Steps you can follow without thinking

An agent writes each ask as an instructable: a small JSON document with a title, a reason, numbered steps and a final check. Hook checks it before showing it, then gives every command its own Copy button.



Done steps fold to a ✓; the current step is open and outlined.

`title`	One line that says what to do. The same title isn't posted twice within 24 hours.
`why`	One sentence on what it unblocks.
`urgency`	`now` notifies and slides the panel in, `today` notifies, `whenever` waits quietly. You can change which ones notify.
`steps`	One to twenty, with sub-steps. Each says what to do and where, with an exact command to copy, a page or a document to open, what you should see, or a question to answer.
`verify`	A last check that proves it worked.
`reply`	A typed answer, or one of up to six choices.
`done`	What must be finished before Done turns on. See section 04.
`from`	Filled in for you: the folder, the Mac and the session, with a command that resumes it.

Secrets never travel in an ask.

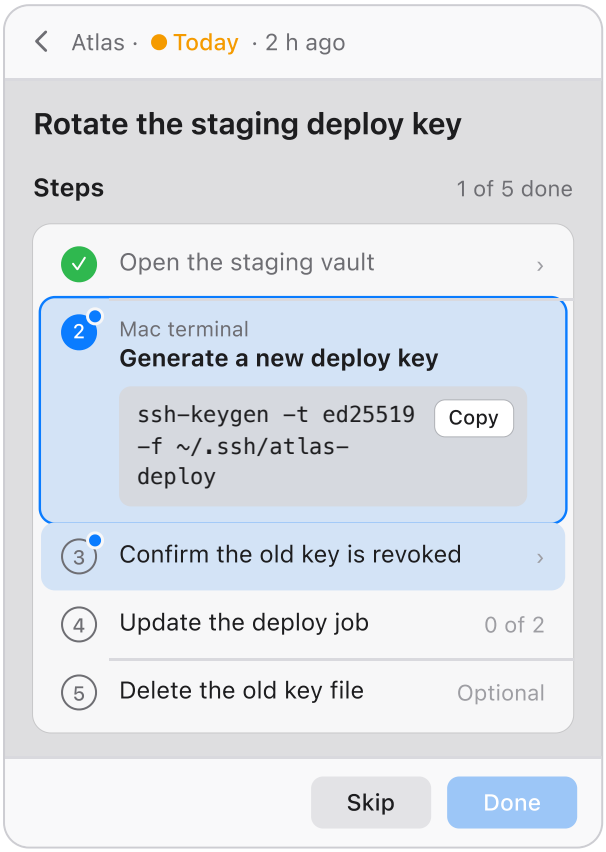
Hook refuses anything that looks like an API key, a token or a private key, and hidden characters that could disguise one. When a session needs a secret, its steps have you store it in the macOS Keychain, and the session reads it from there.

04

BEFORE DONE

Finish what the session can't do without

An ask can mark the steps it can't do without, and can also wait for your reply or a message from you. Done stays off until every marked item is finished. Skip always works.



A dot on the step number and a tinted row mark what's left. Each mark clears the moment its item is finished.

ON A STEP	WHAT YOU SEE
`required`	A mark on the step number. Done stays off until it is ticked, its question answered, or every sub-step finished.
`blocking`	A tinted warning box. The steps after it stay locked (“Finish step 2 first”) until it is done.
`optional`	“Optional” at the end of the row. You can tick it done without doing it.
`done`	On the ask: any of `steps`, `reply` and `message` must be finished first.

Order or finishing

`blocking` is about order; `required` is about finishing. A step can be both, but never required and optional.

Where it works

Required items need a Pond 1.3.0 or newer. This Mac mode doesn't take them yet, and the session's post is refused with a clear message. Telegram shows no Done button until everything is finished.

```
$ relay status 7f3a2c1e
open · Atlas · Rotate the staging deploy key
Left before Done: step 2, step 3, the reply
```

The session can see what's left, and knows not to treat your answer as finished until it is.

05

DAY TO DAY

Using Hook

The menu-bar icon

A red badge counts waiting asks from 1 to 9, and turns into a dot from 10 up. Hover for a summary. Right-click for Presence, Refresh, Panel, Settings, About, Check for Updates and Quit.

The panel

Docked to the left or right edge of any display, full height. Drag it by its top bar to move it. A “now” ask slides it in without taking focus from the app you're typing in.

The queue

Group by project or urgency, filter to one project, and find the last 24 hours under Recently closed, each with Reopen. The status bar shows This Mac or your Pond; click it to switch.

An ask

Tick steps as you go. Copy takes a command exactly as shown, with no trailing newline, so a paste never runs by itself. Questions on a step each have their own Send.

KEYS	WHAT THEY DO
^⌥⌘R	Show, focus or hide the panel from any app. Change or turn off the shortcut in Settings › General.
↑ ↓ ↩	Move through the list and open an ask.
⌘↩ ⌘⌫	Done or Skip. With something unsent, Done warns first.
⌘T ⇧⌘C	Tick the current step; copy its code.
⌘S	Send every unsent step answer and keep the ask open.
⌘L	Focus the reply field, or the Messages field on an ask without a reply prompt.
^⌘G ^⌘P	Switch grouping; show only this project.
⌘Z	Undo the latest Done or Skip.
Esc	Back to the list, then hide the panel.

Closed something by mistake?

An Undo bar shows for 10 seconds after Done or Skip, and Hook sends your answer only after that. Later, open Recently closed and click Reopen.

06

SETTINGS

Five tabs, one config file

TAB	WHAT YOU SET THERE
General	The shortcut, presence and away time, start at login, the badge count, where documents open, the terminal for Resume Session, Privacy (crash reports and the activity log), appearance and updates.
Panel	The edge and display, Re-dock Now, whether “now” asks slide the panel in, and what happens after Done or Skip.
Queue	This Mac only or Pond, how long closed asks stay, the Pond's address and token file, its connection and version, Send a Test Ask, and the owner key.
Notifications	Which urgencies notify, sound, permission and a test notification.
Agents	Every coding agent on this Mac and what Hook set up in it, Reinstall All, and Set up new agents automatically.

Every “?” button explains its row. Settings writes `~/.config/relay/config.json`, and Hook applies an edit to that file without a restart.

First run

A new install opens Set Up Hook: where asks come from, your agents, notifications, the shortcut and login item, and a test ask. Anything you skip is in Settings. Run it again from About Hook.

Away mode

When the screen locks, the displays sleep or you've been idle for 10 minutes, Hook marks you away: no slide-ins, no notifications. When you're back, one notification counts what arrived.

Documents in a step

A step can point to a file on your Mac. Hook opens Markdown and text in its own offline viewer, and other documents in their app. It never opens apps, scripts or installers.

Resume Session

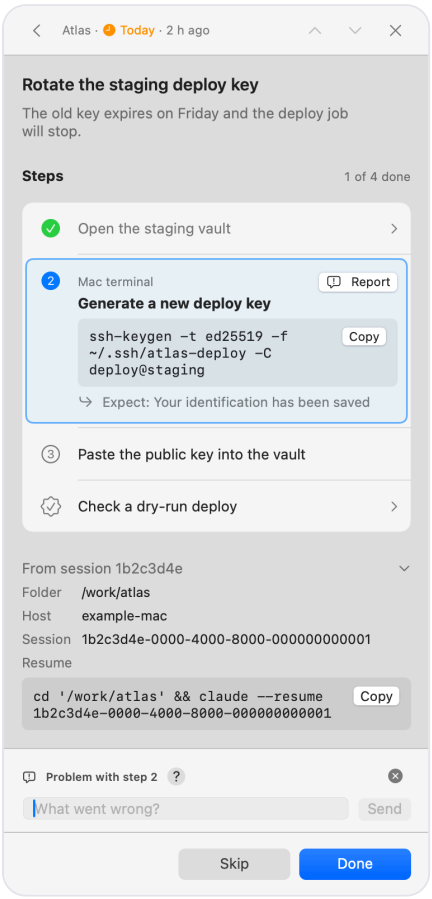
From a card or an ask's ⋯ menu, opens a new terminal window in the session's folder and resumes the Claude Code session that asked. Pick the terminal in Settings › General.

07

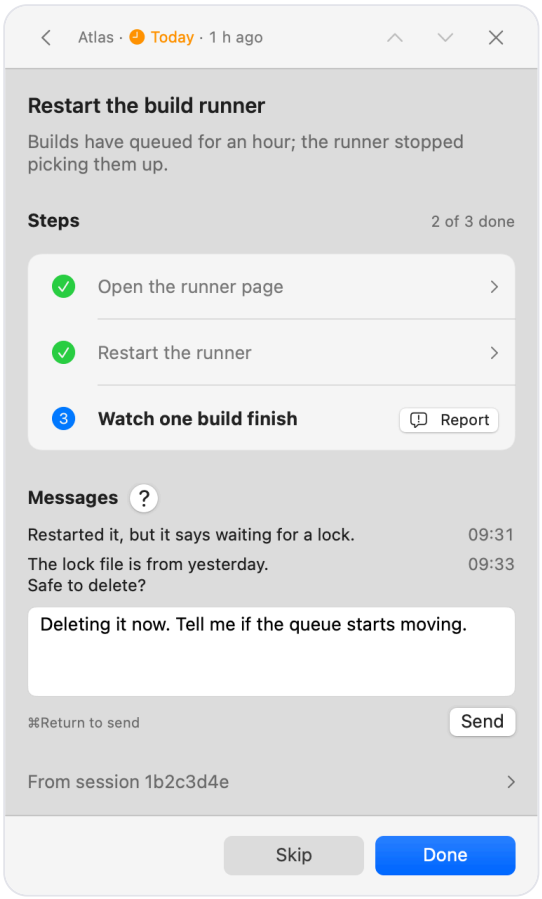
TALKING TO THE SESSION

Say something without opening its terminal

With a Pond, you can reach the session that posted an ask from the ask itself. Neither works in This Mac mode, and the Pond refuses a note or message that looks like a secret.



Report on step 2: one line, Return sends, Esc cancels.



Messages: a side note, like typing in the session's chat.

Report a Problem

An open step with code or a tick ends with a Report button. Type what went wrong in one line, up to 300 characters. The session gets it as a quoted report about that step, never as an instruction, and the step shows a filled icon until the session corrects it. Needs this Mac's owner key.

Messages

With a Pond 1.2.0 or newer, an open ask has a Messages section. A message answers, closes and changes nothing; only the session that posted the ask sees it. ⌘↩ sends.

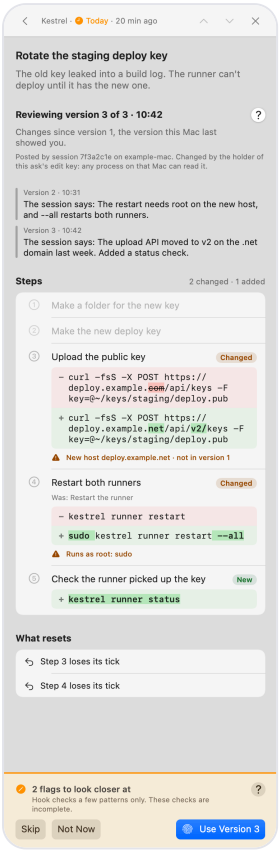
Verified or not

A message counts as yours only when Hook signed it with this Mac's owner key. Sessions treat an unsigned one as data and tell you about it.

08

CORRECTIONS

A changed ask waits for your review



The review: every reason the session gave, one diff, and flags to look closer at.

A session can correct an ask it posted while it is open, such as a wrong port or a missing step, instead of closing it and posting a new one. Hook checks the whole history first: every version is hashed and names the one before.

The ask locks

Until you review it, Copy, links, files, answers, ticks and Done are off. Skip always works.

One diff

From the version you last accepted on this Mac to the newest, with changed, new and moved steps marked.

Look closer

Hook flags a new host, `sudo`, `rm -rf`, a download piped into a shell, `eval` and non-ASCII characters. These checks are incomplete: no flag never means safe.

Use Version N

Accepting a changed command, link or file asks for Touch ID or your password.

09

THE OWNER KEY

Your answers, told apart from a session's

1. Open Settings › Queue › Owner Key and press **Set Up This Mac...**. Hook makes a key in your Keychain and shows a six-digit code.
2. The Pond sends a request to your Telegram. Check it shows the same code, then tap Approve. If it doesn't, or you didn't start this, tap Refuse.
3. Once two Macs are approved, **Require Owner Key...** stops sessions and scripts from answering, pressing Done or reopening as you.

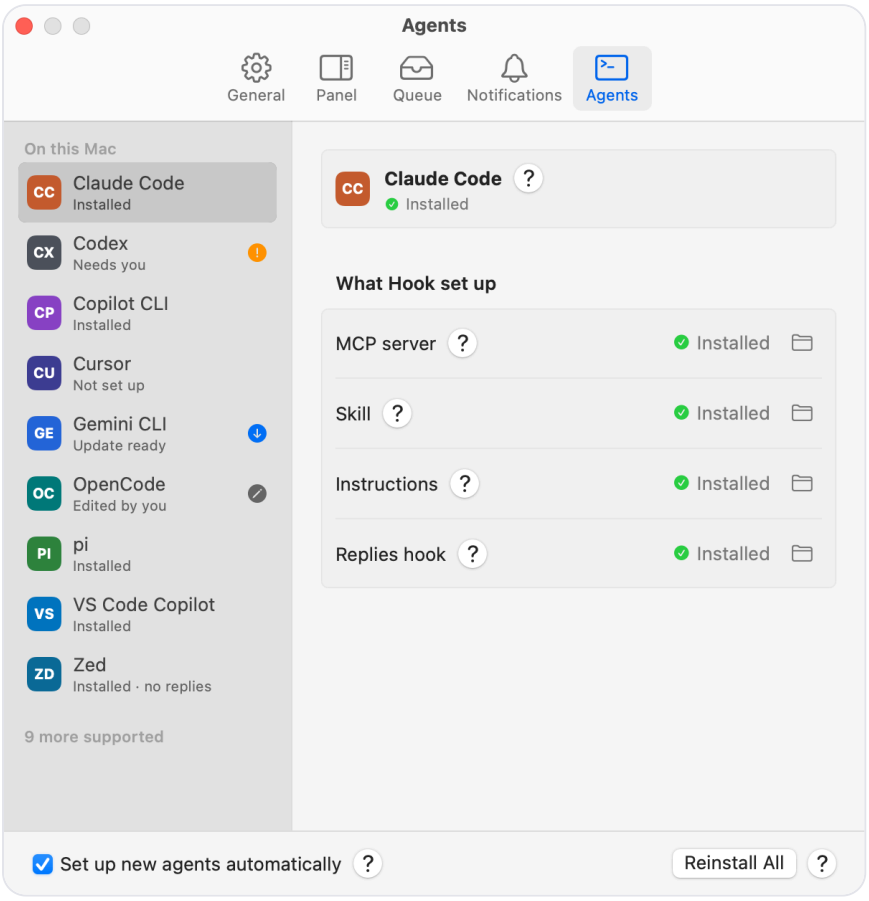
The Pond stores only the key's hash. Corrections and the owner key need a Pond 1.1.0 or newer at an https address.

10

AGENTS

One install sets up every agent

Hook sets itself up in every coding agent it finds on your Mac, keeps that setup in step with each Hook update, tells you when you've edited something it wrote, and removes exactly what it wrote.



Settings › Agents: each agent and the state of each piece. An edited piece offers Keep Mine, Show Difference and Use Hook's.

Four pieces

The `relay` MCP server, the instructables skill, one short instructions text and, where the agent has one, the replies hook. Each goes in the agent's own way: its CLI, a plugin, a file Hook owns, one key or a marked block.

Kept up to date

Setup runs at the end of every install and update, after launch when something changed, and daily. Configs point at a stable path, so an update never needs approving again.

Your edits stay yours

Hook records a hash of everything it writes. It never overwrites a file you edited without asking, and never rewrites a file that doesn't parse.

Your steps

Anything only you can do, such as trusting Hook's hook in Codex or reloading Cursor, arrives once as an ask in your queue.

11

SUPPORTED AGENTS

Eighteen agents, one queue

Replies says when your answers show in a session: before each prompt, at session start (the last 24 hours), or not at all, in which case the session checks with `relay_list`. **Tested** says whether the entry has been tried on a real Mac yet, or follows the agent's docs and Hook's fixture tests only.

AGENT	SET UP THROUGH	REPLIES	YOUR STEP	TESTED
Claude Code	Hook plugin, user MCP server, rules file	per prompt	none	NOT YET
Codex	`codex mcp add`, AGENTS.md block, hooks	per prompt	Trust the hook in /hooks, once	NOT YET
Gemini CLI	extension	per prompt	none	NOT YET
Antigravity CLI	plugin	session start	none	FROM DOCS
Copilot CLI	`copilot mcp add`, instructions file, hooks	session start	none	NOT YET
VS Code Copilot	Copilot CLI's files	session start	none	FROM DOCS
Cursor	local plugin	session start	Reload Window after an update	NOT YET
OpenCode	`opencode.json`, plugin	per prompt	none	NOT YET
Zed	`settings.json`, AGENTS.md block	none	none	NOT YET
pi	`mcp.json`, AGENTS.md block, extension	per prompt	none	NOT YET
Devin	`devin mcp add`, rules file	per prompt	none	FROM DOCS
Factory Droid	`droid mcp add`, AGENTS.md block	per prompt	none	FROM DOCS
Kiro	`kiro-cli mcp add`, steering file	none	none	FROM DOCS
Amp	`amp mcp add`, AGENTS.md block, plugin	per prompt	none	FROM DOCS
Cline	`cline mcp add`, rules file	none	none	FROM DOCS
Goose	`config.yaml`, `.goosehints` block	none	none	FROM DOCS
Junie	`mcp.json`, AGENTS.md block	none	none	FROM DOCS
Warp	`.mcp.json`	none	Paste Hook's rule into Settings › AI › Rules	FROM DOCS

Where an agent's command isn't installed, Hook writes the same key into its config file instead. Adding an agent is a data change in `integration/harnesses.json`; the installer has no agent-specific code.

12

FOR THE SESSION

What every agent gets

PIECE	WHAT IT DOES
`relay_post`	Posts an ask and returns its id and a link to open it.
`relay_status`	Reads an ask: its status, who closed it, your answers and messages, and what's left before Done.
`relay_list`	Lists every open ask.
`relay_amend`	Corrects an open ask this Mac posted, with a one-line reason.
The `relay` command	The same from any terminal or script: `post`, `status`, `list`, `done`, `skip`, `replies`, `wait`, `amend`. It is also linked as `hook`.
The instructables skill	Teaches the agent when to ask and how to write steps a person can follow.
The replies hook	Shows your new answers in the session, before each prompt or at session start.

The MCP server and its tools keep their `relay` names from before the rename, so existing sessions, skills and permission lists keep working.

```
$ relay wait 3f2a9c1e
[Acme] Create a Slack channel for Acme
  ↳ owner reply 2026-11-04T09:12:04+00:00: C07ABC123
last seq: 41
```

A session waiting in the background wakes the moment you answer. A burst of step answers wakes it once.

Before posting, the command checks the ask.

`relay post` refuses a value to copy written inside a step's text, such as a URL, a path or a command, and says which sub-step's `code` it belongs in. It also refuses keys your Pond is too old for, before anything is sent.

13

INSTALL

One command, nothing to compile

You need macOS 14 or later and Python 3.9 or later, for the `relay` command and the MCP server. Hook has no third-party Python dependencies.

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/xooxoxxo/hook/main/scripts/get.sh | bash
```

1. The script downloads the latest release and its `SHA256SUMS`, and refuses a zip that doesn't match.
2. It installs Hook.app to `~/Applications`, and the `relay` command, MCP server and skill to `~/.local/share/hook`. It starts Hook and adds it to your login items.
3. Last, it sets up the agents it finds. Open Settings › Agents to see what it did.
4. In Settings › Queue, click Send a Test Ask. A badge appears on the menu-bar icon; open the ask and press Done.

Use the command rather than the zip.

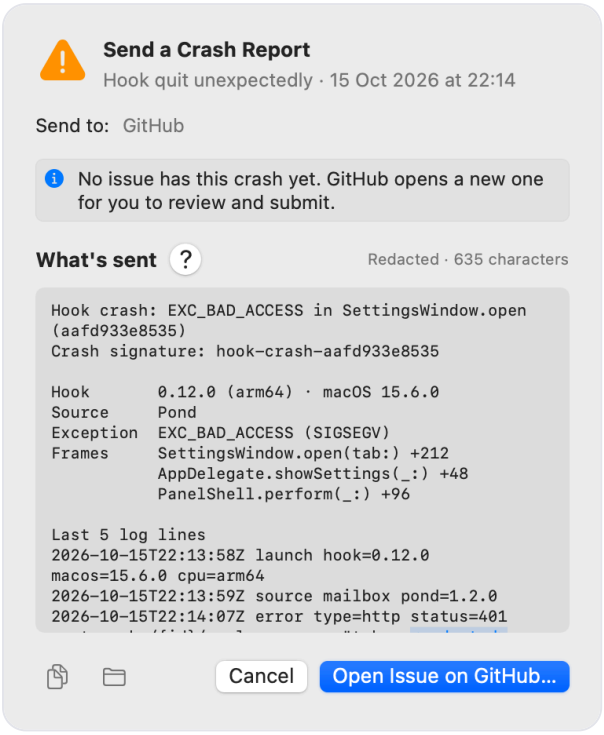
Releases aren't notarized yet, so macOS blocks a `Hook-<version>.zip` downloaded in a browser. A curl download isn't quarantined. The zip and its checksums are on the latest release at github.com/xooxoxxo/hook/releases.

TO	DO THIS
Update	Check for Updates… in the menu-bar menu or Settings › General. Hook downloads, checks and installs the release in the background, and restarts. Running the one-liner again does the same. Your settings are kept.
Keep it local	Add `| bash -s -- --local` to the one-liner to use This Mac only.
Go back	A failed update links the version before back in place. Nothing is removed until a new version installs.
Uninstall	`~/.local/share/hook/current/scripts/install.sh --uninstall` removes what Hook set up in your agents, then the app, login item and command links. It keeps your config and queue, and prints their paths.

14

CRASH REPORTS AND PRIVACY

Nothing leaves without you



Review... shows exactly what a send delivers, with each redacted value tinted.

If Hook quit unexpectedly, the next launch docks a bar in the panel: **Hook quit unexpectedly**, with Not Now and Review.... Nothing has been sent at that point.

GitHub

The default. Hook opens a prefilled issue in your browser for you to submit, or the existing issue for the same crash. Before that it makes one search for the crash's 12-character signature, a hash.

My Pond

Files the report on your own Pond as a Hook bug, signed with the owner key.

Your choice

Settings › General › Privacy: Ask Each Time, Send Automatically (to your Pond) or Off.

A report holds

Hook and macOS versions, CPU type, the queue source and Pond version, the exception and Hook's own frames, and the last 40 lines of the activity log, redacted twice. Never the macOS crash file itself.

The activity log never holds

Ask ids, titles, step text, replies, answers, messages, file paths inside asks, tokens, the owner key or your Pond's address. It records typed events only, and stays on this Mac.

No crash-reporting service is linked into Hook. The log is `~/Library/Logs/Hook/hook.log`; it rolls at 512 KB, so the two files stay under 1 MB.

15

SECURITY

Safe to run on a work Mac

In This Mac only mode, the queue never leaves the Mac. Hook talks only to programs on the same Mac that hold its key.

> **Local only**
>
> Hook listens on 127.0.0.1, never the network. Every call needs a 256-bit token kept in a file only your account can read.

> **Web pages can't reach it**
>
> Requests from a browser are refused and no CORS headers are sent, so a website can't post asks or read them.

> **Sessions can't answer for you**
>
> Only the app records your answers, and every answer says who closed the ask. With Require the owner key on, sessions and scripts can't act as you on the Pond either.

> **Corrections are checked**
>
> A corrected ask stays locked until you review it, and a history that changed on the Pond stops every act but Skip.

> **What you see is what you copy**
>
> Hidden characters show as ‹U+200B›, links show their real host, and Copy never adds a newline that would run a command.

> **Documents only**
>
> A file in a step opens only if it is a known document type on a local disk. Apps, scripts, installers and network paths are never opened.

> **Quiet logs**
>
> Logs hold typed events and redacted errors, never tokens or the text of an ask.

The threat model and what Hook doesn't defend against are in SECURITY.md in the repository. Report a vulnerability privately, from the repository's Security tab, never in a public issue.
